

A stylized illustration of a man with dark, curly hair, wearing a blue jacket over a white shirt. He is shown from the chest up, with his right hand resting on his chin in a thoughtful pose. The entire scene is set against a light beige, textured background.

Which lunch change
could improve service
without hurting profit?

Total revenue
\$1,016.00

Gross profit
\$633.60

Burger gross profit
\$313.20

2 customer
notes



What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

A restaurant owner has lunch sales and customer notes, but does not know which small change could improve service without hurting profit. The table contains clues, not a ready-made answer.

TARGET

Learning goal

Read the table, calculate and verify revenue and gross profit, separate facts from interpretations, and propose one small test.

Practice material: CSV: `session_2_1_restaurant_sales.csv`

Use every supplied row

The complete small practice dataset is reproduced here for spreadsheet work.

day	item	units_sold	unit_price_USD	unit_food_cost_USD	customer_note
Monday	Burger	18	9.00	3.60	Popular at lunch
Monday	Salad	10	8.00	2.80	Asked for faster pickup
Monday	Wrap	14	8.50	3.10	Popular with office customers
Tuesday	Burger	24	9.00	3.60	Long lunch queue
Tuesday	Soup	12	6.50	2.00	Sold out at 1 PM
Wednesday	Salad	8	8.00	2.80	Customers asked for more dressing
Wednesday	Wrap	18	8.50	3.10	Popular at lunch
Wednesday	Burger	16	9.00	3.60	Long lunch queue

Fictional instructional data from data/session_2_1_restaurant_sales.csv.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Read the rows before asking for a recommendation

- Each row describes one item on one day. `units_sold` is a quantity, `unit_price_USD` is the sale price for one unit, and `unit_food_cost_USD` is the food cost for one unit. The `customer_note` field records an observation, not a verified cause. Before calculating, check that all eight rows are present and that prices and costs are in dollars.

LEARN

Calculate the two numbers this table supports

- Revenue for a row is units sold multiplied by unit price. Gross profit for a row is units sold multiplied by the difference between unit price and unit food cost. Add row results to get the totals. The supplied check is \$1,016.00 revenue and \$633.60 gross profit; Burger gross profit is \$313.20. Gross profit here excludes labor, rent, and other operating expenses, so do not call it net profit.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Separate a finding from a cause

- A fact is directly supported by the table, such as a checked total. An interpretation explains what a fact might mean. A customer note about a long queue is a service clue, but these sales rows do not record staffing or wait times. Do not claim the notes prove why the queue formed. A useful next step is a small two-week service test with average wait time and gross profit checked before and during the test.

APPLY

Three-step method

- Read the fields and gaps; calculate and check the totals; explain what the evidence supports, name what is uncertain, and choose one small test.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

AVOID

Weak example 1

Here is our restaurant data. What should we improve?

AVOID

Weak example 2

Add all sales rows, tell me the exact profit, and guarantee your total is correct.

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

USE

Improved example 1

Use only the attached Session 2.1 CSV. List what each column measures.
Separate facts visible in the rows from questions the data cannot answer.
Do not calculate totals or claim a cause. End with three questions for the owner.

USE

Improved example 2

Use the eight Session 2.1 rows and these spreadsheet-checked results:
total revenue \$1,016.00, gross profit \$633.60, Burger gross profit \$313.20.
Give one demand fact, one profit fact, and one service clue.
Suggest one small two-week test and one measure.
Do not recalculate.
Label facts and interpretations separately.

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Open the CSV in Excel or Google Sheets. Columns A-F are day, item, units, unit price, unit food cost, and note. In G2 enter `=C2D2` for revenue; in H2 enter `=C2(D2-E2)` for gross profit. Fill both through row 9. In G10 enter `=SUM(G2:G9)`; in H10 enter `=SUM(H2:H9)`. Check: revenue \$1,016.00; gross profit \$633.60; Burger gross profit \$313.20. Then run Improved Prompt 2 and label each claim fact or interpretation.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Choose one action: prepare Burger ingredients before noon, add a pickup sign, or assign one staff member to pickup. Measure average lunch wait time for several days before the change and for two weeks during it. Also compare gross profit.

How to know the work is complete

Check the output before sharing or acting on it.

SUBMIT

Deliverable

- Three statements: observed problem, one change tested, and measured result for wait time and gross profit.

VERIFY

Success check

- Reproduce the checked values, distinguish a fact from an interpretation, and state how the test will be measured.